A-A-20030
September 18, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SALAD DRESSING MIXES

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description for the procurement of Salad Dressing Mixes for use by the Federal Government.

Salient Characteristics.

Salad dressing mixes specified shall be prepared from sugar, spices, thickener such as algin derivatives or vegetable gum, and ingredients as may be specified for the specific type of dressing mix. Permissible optional ingredients in addition to those that may be specified for the specific type of dressing are: monosodium glutamate, artificial or natural flavors, artificial color, starch, lecithin, mono and diglycerides, phosphates, lactose, salt, dextrose, dehydrated vegetables, herbs, hydrolyzed vegetable protein, vegetable oil, preservatives, or other safe and suitable ingredients approved by the Food and Drug Administration. Deliveries shall conform to all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

A. Bleu cheese. Bleu cheese salad dressing mix shall conform to the basic requirements of above and shall include dried Roquefort, bleu cheese, or a combination thereof.

B. Caesar. Caesar salad dressing mix shall conform to the basic requirements of above and shall include dried Parmesan cheese and may include dehydrated sour cream, anchovy powder, nonfat dry milk, dehydrated pimento, red bell peppers, shallots, powdered mustard, croutons, bacon bits, or other cheeses as optional ingredients.

C. Thousand Island. Thousand Island salad dressing mix shall conform to the basic requirements of above and may include pickle relish mix as an optional ingredient.

D. Italian. Italian salad dressing mix shall conform to the basic requirements of above and may include tomato crystals and bell pepper flakes as optional ingredients.

E. French. French salad dressing mix shall conform to the basic requirements of above and may include tomato powder as an optional ingredient.

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F. Buttermilk style. Buttermilk style dressing mix does not conform to the basic requirements above, but shall contain modified starch, dehydrated vegetables, and spices, and may contain calcium stearate, buttermilk solids, whey solids, lactic acid, casein, or any other permissible ingredients not otherwise specified.

Finished Product.

The finished salad dressing mixes shall comply with the requirements specified below:

A. Physical requirements. The product shall be a uniform, free flowing mix. It shall be free from grit, dirt, and other extraneous materials.

B. Chemical requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following moisture requirements:

Salad dressing	Maximum Moisture (Percent by weight)
Bleu cheese	2.5
Caesar	3.0
Thousand Island	2.0
Italian	2.0
French	2.75
Buttermilk Style	2.5

C. Prepared salad dressing. The reconstituted mixes, when prepared according to the label directions, shall have a flavor and texture typical of the pertinent type of product indicated.

Contractor's Certification.

The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; is the same product sold on the commercial market; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories or possesions; and is sold on the commercial market with commercial sales to the public sector predominating over sales to the Federal Government. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery, from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

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Packaging.

A. Commercial Packaging. The salad dressing mixes shall be packaged in a net weight sufficient to yield one to two gallons of finished product when prepared in accordance with the instructions on the label. The package shall be a flexible type package normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

B. Commercial Packing. Packing shall be in accordance with commercial packing complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

C. Export Packaging. The salad dressing mixes shall be packaged in a net weight sufficient to yield one to two gallons of finished product when prepared in accordance with the instructions on the label. The package shall be a flexible type package normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

D. Export Packing. Packing shall be in snug-fitting fiberboard boxes constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, grade W5c, or W5s of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping of pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Labeling (Commercial and Export). Labeling of packages shall be in accordance with commercial practice and shall comply with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The label shall show directions for use information.

F. Marking (Commercial and Export). Commercial markings on shipping containers are acceptable, provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Quantity, Size, and Unit
Date of Pack (month/year)
Contract Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor

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Notes.

Sources of Documents:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606

Civil agencies may obtain copies of this Commercial Item Description, without charge, from General Services Administration's Regional Business Service Centers, or:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, S.W.
Washington, DC 20407
Telephone: (202) 472-2205

Military activities should submit request for copies to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19120

MILITARY INTEREST:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
DOT - CG
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FQA
VA - OSS

Review Activities

Army - MD
Navy - MS, MC
DLA - SS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

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